funding from outside of Pakistan at the time and also had strong ties to elements of the wider Deobandi infrastructure that existed inside Pakistan. While it received funding from the Pakistani intelligence service for the Kashmir jihad, these other means of support meant HuA could continue to operate independently, were official funding cut off.[36] Its ties to the Deobandi infrastructure also meant it was connected to the Jamiat Ulema-e-Islam [JUI], which had become a party in the ruling coalition after aligning itself with the victorious Pakistan People's Party [PPP] in the 1993 elections. This meant the HuA had a potential political patron, though the degree to which anyone within the JUI could influence the group's activities in Indian-administered Kashmir is unclear.

HuA's unreliability was borne out after the Indian security forces arrested HuA leaders Maulana Masood Azhar and Sajjad Afghani in February 1994. The group's Kashmir branch responded by embarking on a series of kidnappings with the intention of bartering hostages' lives for the release of its jailed leaders. After failing to secure their release by kidnapping an Indian major, the group snatched two British hostages who it later released under pressure from Islamabad, the APHC and other militant groups. Undeterred, HuA took another group of Westerners hostage in September 1994. This time Omar Saeed Sheikh, who was later convicted in Pakistan of involvement in *Wall Street Journal* reporter Daniel Pearl's murder, lured three Britons and one American away from Delhi to a farmhouse where they were held at gunpoint. The hostages were rescued, and Saeed Sheikh arrested, after one of the kidnappers inadvertently drew the attention of nearby policemen to the farmhouse where the hostages were held. Yet another kidnapping occurred in July 1995, when two Americans, two British citizens, a German and a Norwegian were abducted in Kashmir. A group called Al Faran, suspected at the time of being a front for HuA in Kashmir, claimed credit.[37]

It is unclear whether the HuA leadership in Pakistan sanctioned any of these kidnappings, and there is evidence to suggest that local actors were driving the final operation in 1995. Talks broke down to free those hostages when the Norwegian hostage was killed. Indian authorities later captured one of the militants involved, who asserted that by the time of the final kidnapping the group was fractured and the Kashmir-based leadership of the HuA had become 'anti-Pakistani.'[38] Regardless of where the